

We've all heard the same phrase: "Make sure you study!" Yet, teachers often never tell us *how* to study or *where* to study, leaving students to fend for themselves, struggling and losing valuable time as the test tomorrow approaches closer and closer.

On this page, we have put together a list of resources we've found useful in our studying, helping us and many other students achieve A's in class and 5's on AP exams.

Of course, there *are* other resources scattered around the internet. However, these resources have been proven to help *thousands* of students, and ourselves, too.

There are thousands of educational websites and YouTube channels available online, but not all of them are equally effective. The resources below have consistently helped students improve their understanding, earn higher grades, and score well on AP exams as well as standardized tests like the SAT. Whether you're trying to learn a new concept, review before an exam, or find extra practice, these are excellent places to start.

Study resources

Resource	Category	Short Description
Khan Academy	Website	Free lessons, videos, and practice for math, science, history, AP courses, and SAT prep.
College Board AP Classroom	Website	Official AP videos, progress checks, and practice exams.
Fiveable	Website	AP study guides, cram sessions, and practice questions.
Albert.io	Website	AP-level practice questions with detailed explanations.
Quizlet	Study Tool	Flashcards, games, quizzes, and study sets for every subject.
Anki	Study Tool	Uses spaced repetition to improve long-term memory.
Knowt	Study Tool	Notes, flashcards, quizzes, explanations, MCQ, FRQ practice
CK-12 Foundation	Website	Free digital textbooks, simulations, and interactive lessons.
OpenStax	Website	College-level textbooks available for free.

Desmos	Math Tool	Interactive graphing calculator for Algebra and Calculus.
GeoGebra	Math Tool	Dynamic software for graphing, geometry, and algebra.
Wolfram Alpha	Math Tool	Solves math problems with step-by-step explanations.
Symbolab	Math Tool	Step-by-step solutions for algebra, trigonometry, and calculus.
Grammarly	Writing Tool	Checks grammar, spelling, and writing clarity.
Purdue OWL	Writing Tool	Trusted resource for essays, MLA, APA, and grammar.
SparkNotes	English	Literature summaries, themes, and character analysis.
LitCharts	English	Detailed literature guides with quotes and themes.
Google Docs	Productivity	Organize notes and collaborate on assignments.
Notion	Productivity	Organize notes, homework, calendars, and study plans.
Forest	Productivity	Focus timer that helps reduce phone distractions.
Pomofocus	Productivity	Free Pomodoro timer for effective study sessions.
Heimler's History	YouTube	Best for AP histories like AP World, APUSH, AP Gov, and AP Euro review, as well as explaining DBQs, SAQs, LEQs, and MCQ writing and strategies.
Jacob Clifford	YouTube	The top resource for AP Macroeconomics, AP Microeconomics, and personal finance.
Mr. Sinn	YouTube	Excellent AP Psychology, AP Human Geography reviews, vocab, FRQs, and unit summaries.
Amoeba Sisters	YouTube	Fun animations that simplify Biology and AP Biology concepts.
Bozeman Science	YouTube	Detailed science lessons for Biology, Chemistry, Physics, and Environmental Science.

Organic Chemistry Tutor	YouTube	Clear step-by-step explanations for Math, Chemistry, and Physics.
Tyler DeWitt	YouTube	Makes chemistry concepts easy to understand.
Flipping Physics	YouTube	Comprehensive AP Physics lessons and problem solving.
Professor Dave Explains	YouTube	Covers science and math topics from beginner to advanced.
Crash Course	YouTube	Fast-paced videos on history, economics, psychology, literature, and science.
3Blue1Brown	YouTube	Beautiful visual explanations of higher-level math concepts.
MinutePhysics	YouTube	Short videos explaining physics concepts intuitively.
Veritasium	YouTube	Science experiments and real-world applications of scientific ideas.
TED-Ed	YouTube	Animated educational videos across many school subjects.
Science with Susanna	YouTube	AP Biology review, practice questions, and exam preparation.
Freesciencelessons	YouTube	Straightforward Biology, Chemistry, and Physics lessons.
Simple History	YouTube	Animated history videos covering important events and civilizations.
Oversimplified	YouTube	Humorous history animations that make learning memorable.
Crash Course Study Skills	YouTube	Teaches note-taking, memory, productivity, and study strategies.
Gohar Khan	YouTube	Study tips, productivity, college admissions, and learning techniques.
Garden of English	YouTube	AP English Language and Literature writing and analysis help.

Marco Learning	YouTube	AP exam reviews, FRQs, scoring guides, and test strategies.
Princeton Review	YouTube	SAT, ACT, and AP preparation with test-taking strategies.
Kaplan Test Prep	YouTube	Standardized test prep, study skills, and AP review videos.

Resources per class

Subject	Recommended Resources
AP Human Geography	Khan Academy, Fiveable, AP Classroom
KAP/AP Biology	Amoeba Sisters, Bozeman Science, Science with Susanna, Khan Academy
AP Physics	Flipping Physics, Organic Chemistry Tutor, Bozeman Science, Khan Academy
Chemistry	Tyler DeWitt, Organic Chemistry Tutor, Professor Dave Explains
Math	Khan Academy, Organic Chemistry Tutor, 3Blue1Brown, Desmos, Symbolab, Mario's Math tutoring, Eddie Woo, Mr H Tutoring, Brian McLogan
AP History	Heimler's History, Crash Course, Simple History, Oversimplified
AP Economics	Jacob Clifford, Khan Academy, AP Classroom
English	Garden of English, Purdue OWL, Grammarly, LitCharts
SAT/ACT	Khan Academy, Princeton Review, Gohar Khan, Crackd, CookSAT, or in-person test prep, e.g., Testmasters, but can be expensive
Study Skills	Crash Course Study Skills, Forest, Pomofocus, Anki, Notion

Different types of assessment require different amounts of time spent on preparation. These recommendations can help you avoid rushing, last-minute cramming, while still giving yourself enough time to understand the material

Example routines when studying for quizzes/tests

Assessment	Typical Length	Minimum Study Time	Ideal Study Time	Goal
Quiz (MCQ)	20–30 questions	35–45 min	45–60 min	Understand concepts and practice questions.
Quiz (FRQ)	1–3 FRQs	35–45 min	45–60 min	Practice writing and reviewing scoring guidelines.
Test	30–60 questions	1 hr 30 min	2–3 hours	Master all units, vocabulary, and practice problems.
Unit Exam (AP/KAP)	50–70 questions + FRQ	2–3 hours	3–4 hours	Combine review, practice tests, and error analysis.
Final Exam	Multiple Units	4–8 hours (over several days)	1–2 weeks of review	Comprehensive review of every unit.

Stages of study

Stage	Purpose	Best Resources	How to Use It
Pre-Study (Before Class)	Learn the basics before the teacher introduces them.	Khan Academy, Heimler, Mr. Sinn, Amoeba Sisters, Flipping Physics	Watch one lesson (10–20 min), then take brief notes so class feels like a review instead of new material.
After School Practice	Reinforce what you learned the same day.	AP Classroom, Albert.io, Quizlet, Knowt, Desmos, Symbolab	Complete practice questions, review mistakes, and make flashcards for new vocabulary.

Understanding Difficult Topics	Learn concepts from a different explanation.	Organic Chemistry Tutor, Bozeman Science, Professor Dave, Tyler DeWitt, 3Blue1Brown	Watch the specific lesson you're struggling with and pause to solve examples before continuing.
Cramming (Night Before)	Refresh important concepts quickly.	Fiveable, Heimler Review Videos, Mr. Sinn Unit Reviews, Quizlet, Knowt	Review summary guides, vocabulary, and complete one practice quiz. Avoid learning brand-new material.
Exam Day Review (10–30 min)	Recall key information before the test.	Flashcards, Knowt, Quizlet, Your Notes	Review formulas, vocabulary, diagrams, and common mistakes only.

SAT & ACT are very important and vital in order to get to college. These provided resources contain practice tests, personalized instructions, and preparation tutoring. While some of these can be expensive, it is worth the price to direct students for competitive colleges.

Resource	Type	Description
TestMasters	In-Person & Online	Highly regarded Texas-based SAT/ACT prep with experienced instructors, high-level instruction, and realistic practice tests
Princeton Review	Online & In-Person	Comprehensive SAT and ACT courses, tutoring, and practice exams.
Kaplan Test Prep	Online & In-Person	Offers self-paced courses, live classes, tutoring, and extensive question banks.
PrepScholar	Online	Personalized SAT and ACT prep program that adapts to student performance.
Schoolhouse.world	Free Online	Free SAT tutoring sessions led by volunteer peer tutors in partnership with Khan Academy.
UWorld	Online	Excellent SAT practice questions with detailed answer explanations.
Bluebook	Free SAT Provided by College Board	An excellent free SAT mock test that provided the same environment as the real test

Links: thea.study (not a source, extra study resource link)

